

Shweta Soni vs Gaurav Tandon on 15 September, 2023

Author: Arvind Singh Sangwan

Bench: Arvind Singh Sangwan

Neutral Citation No:=2023:PHHC:121

TA-1192-2023 (O&M)

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Neutral Citation No. 2023:PHHC:121934

IN THE HIGH COURT FOR THE STATES OF PUNJAB AND
HARYANA AT CHANDIGARH

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TA-1192-2023 (O&M)

Date of decision: 15.09.2023

Shweta

...Petitioner

Versus

Gaurav Tandon

...Respondent

CORAM: HON'BLE MR. JUSTICE ARVIND SINGH SANGWAN

Present:- Mr. Divanshu Jain, Advocate
for the petitioner.

ARVIND SINGH SANGWAN, J. (Oral)

Prayer in this petition is for transfer of the petition filed by the respondent-husband under Section 13(1)(ia)(ib) of the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, pending before the Family Court, Panchkula to the competent Court of jurisdiction at Chandigarh.

Learned counsel for the petitioner has argued that a minor son is residing in the care and custody of the petitioner and she, on account of a matrimonial discord, has filed a petition under Section 125 Cr.P.C. and has also got registered an FIR under Sections 406, 498-A IPC at Chandigarh, which are pending. It is further submitted that the respondent-husband has filed the present petition under Section 13(1)(ia)(ib) of the Hindu Marriage Act at Panchkula in order to harass the petitioner. It is further submitted that the petitioner is facing great difficulty in prosecuting the said case, as there is a distance of about 20 Kms between the aforesaid two places.

Learned counsel has relied upon the judgments Sumita Singh 1 of 4 Neutral Citation No:=2023:PHHC:121934 TA-1192-2023 (O&M) -2- Neutral Citation No. 2023:PHHC:121934 Vs. Kumar Sanjay, 2002 SC 396 and Rajani Kishor Pardeshi Vs. Kishor Babulal Pardeshi, 2005(12) SCC 237, wherein the Hon'ble Supreme Court observed that "while deciding the transfer application, the Courts are required to give more weightage and consideration to the convenience of the female litigants and transfer of legal proceedings from one Court to another should ordinarily be allowed, taking into consideration their convenience and the Courts should desist from putting female litigants under undue hardships."

Learned counsel for the petitioner has further relied upon 2022 Live Law (SC) 627 N.C.V. Aishwarya vs. A.S. Saravana Karthik Sha, wherein Hon'ble Supreme Court has held as under:

"9. The cardinal principle for exercise of power under Section 24 of the Code of Civil Procedure is that the ends of justice should demand the transfer of the suit, appeal or other proceeding. In matrimonial matters, wherever Courts are called upon to consider the plea of transfer, the Courts have to take into consideration the economic soundness of both the parties, the social strata of the spouses and their behavioural pattern, their standard of life prior to the marriage and subsequent thereto and the circumstances of both the parties in eking out their livelihood and under whose protective umbrella they are seeking their sustenance to life. Given the prevailing socioeconomic paradigm in the Indian society, generally, it is the wife's convenience which must be looked at while considering transfer.

10. Further, when two or more proceedings are pending in different Courts between the same parties which raise common question of fact and law, and when the decisions in the cases are interdependent, it is desirable

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It is well settled that while considering the transfer of a matrimonial dispute/case at the instance of the wife, the Court is to consider family condition of the wife, custody of the minor child, economic condition of the wife, her physical health and earning capacity of the husband and most important, convenience of the wife i.e. she cannot travel alone without assistance of a male member of her family, connectivity of the place to and fro from her place of residence as well as bearing of the litigation charges and travelling expenses.

After hearing the counsel for the petitioner, considering the fact that issuance of notice to the respondent has the consequences of staying further proceedings before the trial Court, otherwise the petitioner-wife will have to bear the litigation expenses and transportation expenses and in view of the fact that in case notice of motion is issued, even the respondent/husband has to bear the litigation expenses and in also in view of the judgments rendered in Sumita Singh's case, Rajani Kishor Pardeshi's case as well as N.C.V. Aishwarya's case (supra), this Court deems it appropriate to

allow the present petition, with the following directions:-

(i) The petition filed under Section 13(1)(ia)(ib) of the Hindu Marriage Act, pending before the Family Court, Panchkula will be transferred to the competent Court of jurisdiction at Chandigarh.

(ii) The District Judge, Chandigarh will assign the said petition to the competent Court of

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(iii) The Family Court, Panchkula is directed to transfer all the record pertaining to the aforesaid case to District Judge, Chandigarh.

(iv) The parties are directed to appear before the trial Court at Chandigarh within a period of 01 month from today.

(v) The Courts concerned, where the cases are pending between the parties, will accommodate them with one date in a calendar month.

However, liberty is granted to the respondent-husband to revive this petition, if he intends to contest the same, provided that:-

(i) The respondent will clear all the arrears of maintenance amount, if any, in terms of the petition filed by the petitioner either under Section 125 Cr.P.C. or Section 12 of the Domestic Violence Act or Section 24 of the Hindu Marriage Act.

(ii) The respondent will file an affidavit giving undertaking to pay Rs.1,000/- per day, to the petitioner for attending the Court proceedings at Panchkula, on each and every date of hearing.

(iii) The respondent will bring a demand draft of Rs.25,000/- towards the litigation expenses of the petitioner to pursue the case at Panchkula, in case the respondent opts to contest this petition.

15.09.2023 (ARVIND SINGH SANGWAN) Waseem Ansari JUDGE Whether speaking/reasoned Yes/No Whether reportable Yes/No Neutral Citation No:=2023:PHHC:121934 4 of 4